

SCAFFOLD

TEAMS & MEETINGS

FOR INTACT TEAMS

The Handoff Contract

A short template completed at any cross-orientation handoff: **what the receiver needs that the sender wouldn't naturally include**, made explicit in both directions.

THE DRAIN

Handoffs fail in the gap between wirings: WHY energy hands over inspiration and calls it a plan; HOW energy hands over completeness and calls it clarity; WHAT energy hands over urgency and calls it a brief. Each sender includes what their own wiring would need, and the receiver needed something else.

WHAT THIS TOOL DOES

The contract is four questions, answered together in ten minutes at the moment of handoff. It forces the translation each wiring skips: the sender articulates what done means and what they are actually asking for, and the receiver names what their wiring needs to run with it. The gap gets closed while it is still free.

HOW TO USE IT

- 1 Fill it in together, live.** The contract's value is the conversation it forces. Async templates get filled politely and wrongly.
- 2 Let the receiver write line two.** The sender cannot know what they habitually omit. That is the entire point of the line.
- 3 Keep it to one page, always.** A handoff needing more than a page is a project needing a kickoff, use Tool 36.
- 4 Use it on every cross-orientation handoff for a month.** After a month the questions become reflex and the paper becomes optional. The paper trained the habit.

The contract

- | | | |
|----------|---|--|
| 1 | What I'm handing you | The work, its state, and its purpose, three sentences from the sender. |
| 2 | What you need that I wouldn't think to include | The receiver's line, answered from their wiring: the mechanism, the deadline, the why. |
| 3 | What done means | Checkable criteria, agreed now, not discovered at delivery. |
| 4 | When we check back | One midpoint touch, dated, before done is due. |

WHAT IT WON'T DO

A contract cannot fix a handoff of bad work, and it adds ten minutes that trivial handoffs do not need, use it where the orientations differ and the stakes are real. Its deeper effect arrives with repetition: senders start pre-answering line two, which is what cross-wiring fluency actually looks like.

IN THE KIT

One-page contract pad

Wiring-gap examples per pairing

Habit-month tracker

PAIRS WELL WITH

Tool 38 The Friction Forecast · **Tool 25** Vision Extraction Interview · **Tool 7** Definition-of-Done Cards